

Beta and if that's just a teaser of how well the other maps are designed then game should be off to a good start. Over the entire week of game play we never came across a scenario that had either faction pinned at spawn.

There are optimal spots for snipers all over the map so if at all you ever come across a tall structure you can rest assured that there's one crafty bugger camping atop the water tank or on sniper ridge. This can be a menace, especially if the snipers are really good but then again, since these elements are all destructible, you can very well blow these structures to smithereens with a tank.

The full game will also feature other maps such as The St. Quentin Scar, Amiens, Monte Grappa and Empire's Edge.

BATTLEFIELD 1 VEHICLES, TANKS, AIRPLANES ... LAND SHIPS!

Tanks are OP! Huge lumbering, unappealing boxes of metal that appear like moving houses with humongous cannons on all sides. Coming face to face with one of these isn't a pleasant experience as it's pretty much a one way ticket back to spawn.

Going co-op on these tanks could make things even more dangerous for the enemy. Then again, you can hide behind cover and repair your tank so there are ways to survive perennially on the battlefield in a tank.

Tanks are immensely overpowered. As an Assault class or support class you are better equipped to take out vehicles but almost every class has access to anti-tank weapons. And with a few strategically placed anti-tank mines you can take out most vehicles with ease. However, we did notice a lot of people opting for the Assault class just to take out tanks which might end up being a balance issue in the game upon launch.

BATTLEFIELD 1 WEAPONS

Moving away from modern firearms with 50 different mods that ensure pin point accuracy is a much welcome change. Having to worry about

shells losing velocity and dropping along an arc adds a lot of realism. Speaking of weapons, most of them aren't 1-hit unless you happen to get a headshot. And weapons are based on the character class you pick unless of course, you happen to chance upon a weapon cache which could contain a flamethrower or a much accurate bolt action rifle.

The Assault class gets an anti tank hand cannon but you need to go prone in order to shoot it and you don't need us to tell you what happens if you get personal with a tank. Pistols and the semi-automatics are great as well but it would have been a little better if weapons jammed just as often as they did back during World War I.

Oh and while we're on the subject of close quarter combat. Melee weapons are a little barbaric. Clubs, maces and bayonets - each comes with its own characteristic animation. But should you spot your enemy with his back at you then you should definitely charge which makes you hurtle towards them like the hulk till you skewer him like a kebab. Much fun! But each charge is a calculated risk which can act as a kill move, an escape mechanism or get you killed.

The fun begins when you get the Mauser 1918 T-Gewehr which is an anti-tank rifle but you don't have to go prone. While it may be slow to load, you're pretty much ensured a kill.

BATTLEFIELD 1 CHARACTER CLASSES

Most of the combat will be played out among the four primary character classes - Assault, Medic, Support and Scout(sniper). Aside from the primary classes you also get to be a Pilot or a Tanker or a Cavalry horseman. You only end up as these classes if you spawn onto vehicles. If you pick one of the main infantry classes and then jump into a tank, you'll still retain your initial pick. However, for the duration you maintain control, you're temporarily a different class.

Additionally, like the pickup classes in Battlefield 4, we have a similar

feature. They're called the Elite classes. Based on which weapon you pick up, you'll turn into either a Flame-thrower, a Tank-killer or a Sentry. Elite Classes come with armour upgrades and the Sentry looks kick-ass with full body plate armour while rocking a machine gun. The Flame-thrower looks more like a chef with failed cooking experiments. And the Tank Killer is like every other infantry class but he's carrying the 1918 T-Gewehr.

BATTLEFIELD 1 BUGS, BALANCE ISSUES

While the primary classes might have been further broken down, not a lot of people were spotted playing the Support and Medic classes. In fact, during the entire week of the open beta, I was only resurrected once by a squad mate and that too because I was shouting my head off into the mic. Towards the end of the Open Beta, we saw most people picking either the Assault or the Scout class. So class imbalance is a prominent issue.

Sandstorms can completely turn the game around as Snipers are pretty much rendered useless owing to reduced visibility and you don't spot tanks until it's too late. Unless, of course, you have a not so great graphics card. In which case, your visibility isn't that bad and you are at an advantage.

BATTLEFIELD 1 OPEN BETA IMPRESSIONS

Despite of all the shortcomings and balance issues, Battlefield 1 is a lot of fun and just the one map made us go back to the game over and over again. The apparent lack of naval vessels might irk some but we'll reserve our judgement till the final game comes out. We'd say that just the change in setting from a modern day battlefield to a World War 1 Battlefield makes for most of the game's appeal. And if one map can be this fun then we simply can't wait for the final game.

Is it pre-order worthy? Nope. **